

CASE STUDY: UPI/Online Payment Fraud

What the crime is:

Online payment fraud, especially through UPI, has become increasingly common among students and young users. In a typical scenario, a victim receives a call or message from a fraudster posing as a bank representative, delivery agent, or customer support executive. The scammer convinces the victim to click on a malicious link or requests them to share sensitive details such as OTPs or UPI PINs.

How it happens:

In some cases, the attacker sends a “collect request” on a UPI app and tricks the victim into approving it, claiming it is required to receive money. Once the victim authorizes the request, money is instantly transferred from their account.

Target Audience:

Students and individuals unfamiliar with digital payment security are often targeted because they may not fully understand how UPI transactions work. The consequences include financial loss, stress, and difficulty in recovering the money.

Consequences:

Such incidents highlight the importance of digital awareness and cautious behavior while using online payment systems. Users must verify requests, avoid sharing confidential information, and understand that receiving money never requires entering a PIN.

Additionally, fraudsters often use urgency and fear tactics to pressure victims into making quick decisions without thinking. They may claim that an account will be blocked or that a payment is pending to create panic. This psychological manipulation makes it easier to exploit users who are not aware of such tactics.

Real Life Incidents:

A similar type of fraud has been reported in several cases across India. For example, in cities like Mumbai and Delhi, victims have lost money after approving fake UPI collect requests sent by fraudsters posing as bank officials or customer support agents. These incidents highlight how common and dangerous such scams have become.